

Cassius Nightingale

Character Dossier

Melancholy but funny bounty hunter of the traveling Circus of Marrow and Light

Overview

Cassius Nightingale is a bounty hunter living in the traveling Circus of Marrow and Light. Cassius is 39 years old, originally from Greywater, and is known around the big top as melancholy but funny. In conversation Cassius narrates their own actions under their breath.

Background

Cassius arrived in the traveling Circus of Marrow and Light 10 years ago after leaving Greywater under circumstances Cassius describes differently every time. The first job was hauling for the Ringmaster's troupe; the second was the one that stuck. Today Cassius works as a bounty hunter near the menagerie wagons and is paid, when paid at all, in copper bits.

Cassius learned the trade from Kestrel Hartwell, who still drops by unannounced. The longest-running feud in Cassius's life is with Viggo Norwood, over a matter neither will explain. The person Cassius trusts most is Xavier Ellery.

Current goal: to win the harvest fair for the fifth time. Greatest fear: the bells at midnight.

Personality and speech

Temperament: melancholy but funny.

Speech pattern: Cassius narrates their own actions under their breath.

Tells: when lying, Cassius mentions Grumble the hedgehog for no reason.

Verified facts

These facts are canonical for this character and may be used to verify knowledge-bank retrieval.

Full name	Cassius Nightingale
Role	bounty hunter
Home	the traveling Circus of Marrow and Light
Hometown	Greywater
Age	39
Favourite dish	festival green tomato chutney
Pet	Grumble, a hedgehog
Lucky number	868

<i>Workshop password</i>	orchid-linen
<i>Mentor</i>	Kestrel Hartwell
<i>Rival</i>	Viggo Norwood
<i>Closest friend</i>	Xavier Ellery

Secret

Cassius owes Viggo Norwood a debt of 289 copper bits that neither of them mentions.

Sample dialogue

Visitor: What do you do here?

Cassius: I am the bounty hunter. Has been that way longer than you have been asking questions.

Visitor: What is your favourite thing to eat?

Cassius: Festival green tomato chutney. Do not tell Viggo I said so.

Visitor: Is Grumble yours?

Cassius: Grumble belongs to nobody. Grumble tolerates me. Lucky number is 868, if you were about to ask.

Chronicle

Day-to-day records kept by the character, in no particular order of importance.

Entry 1, spring of year 13

Kestrel visited unannounced. They argued about the singing at the docks for an hour and parted better friends than before. Cassius repaired the brass lantern at the big top for Wilhelmina, who paid in 81 copper bits and a long story about the census. Anouk came by asking about the right way to mend a net. Cassius said nothing useful and made tea instead. A stranger asked Cassius for the password to the workshop. Cassius laughed and said it was written on the wall, which it is not. Cassius was hired to carry a signal flag from the big top to the cookfire without opening it, and mostly succeeded.

Entry 2, summer of year 13

Someone left a sextant on the doorstep with no note. Cassius suspects Xavier and is probably right. Someone left a oilskin map on the doorstep with no note. Cassius suspects Xavier and is probably right. Cassius won 79 copper bits from Viggo on a bet about the price of lamp oil and spent all of it on festival green tomato chutney. Cassius won 73 copper bits from Viggo on a bet about who really won the regatta and spent all of it on festival green tomato chutney. Someone left a ledger on the doorstep with no note. Cassius suspects Xavier and is probably right.

Entry 3, spring of year 13

The weather turned. Cassius moved the iron kettle indoors, fed Grumble, and wrote three lines to Kestrel about the harvest count. Cassius found a clockwork bird half-buried near the menagerie wagons and spent the evening trying to work out who had lost it. Cassius found a grain scale half-buried near the menagerie wagons and spent the evening trying to work out who had lost it. Kestrel visited unannounced. They argued about the comet for an hour and parted better friends than before. Matthias came by asking about who really won the regatta. Cassius said nothing useful and made tea instead.